of loss and community. Says Nath, "When I was working on this play, I wanted to combine two things—the floods that happen every year in Assam which destroy lives and property, as well as how people are often duped in the name of God."

Mallika Taneja's *Do You Know This Song?* invites the audience on a journey of grief and rediscovery as she explores love, loss and the power of memory. She shares that she had to work backwards to arrive at the play. "I always knew I wanted the audience to be a part of the play, and I knew I wanted to leave them with a song. I thought if we have to get to a point where we are all singing together, where do we begin?" she says. The winner of the Best Actor in a Lead Role (Female) for *Do You Know This Song?*, Taneja, who is the sole performer on stage, says the play was a result of several motivations, including her interest in non-proscenium theatre, in speaking about grief and loss as well as her desire to sing. ■

–Deepali Dhingra









SING ALONG *(From right clockwise) French 79; Hamza Rahimtula and Rajasthan Folkstars*

MUSIC

Sounds of **Sustainability**

The 7th edition of the **Echoes of Earth** music festival in Bengaluru has an eclectic line-up curated around the seasons

India's first sustainability focused music festival, 'Echoes of Earth', is returning with its seventh edition in Bengaluru. The festival theme this year, 'Symphony of Seasons', explores an eclectic mix of genres, styles, instruments and cultural influences. "Aspects of Spring, Summer, Monsoon and Winter have been brought to life through thematic sections. We also have art installations reflecting the ecosystem and its interdependence with the seasons," says Roshan Netalkar, MD, Swordfish, and festival director, Echoes of Earth.

The festival is collaborating with Kempegowda International Airport for the fifth consecutive year. "This collaboration has seen aesthetic creations from upcycled media and educational initiatives like Namma Shikshana. From repurposing 1,500 kg of e-waste collected at BIAL (Bengaluru International Airport Limited) to larger-than-life art installations to educating travellers about Karnataka's rich fauna, it celebrates a symphony of art, sustainability and collective action," says Netalkar.

Another highlight this year is an audio-visual immersive experience at the solar energy-powered Big Tree stage, the 'Seasonal Soundscape'. A crowd-sourced initiative of sound recordings, it documents the changing seasons–weather, insects, birds and natural elements. Experiential art will also be a focal point at the festival this year. From the hornet and one-horned rhinoceros to monsoon reptiles, every piece has been handmade by local artists. "We have created a Solstice Garden, a one-of-its-kind tech-forward experience demonstrating animation driven by weather movements," says Netalkar.

ECHOES OF EARTH music festival will happen on December 7-8 in Bengaluru

The 2024 line-up features more than 50 artistes, such as Mount Kimbie, Yin Yin, Ko Shin Moon, Cobblestone Jazz, Kid Francescoli and Tarang Joseph among others. Hamza Rahimtula and Rajasthan Folkstars will blend both electronic and organic elements under one umbrella. "Many organic elements, such as Rajasthani instruments, blend seamlessly with house beats, creating a full, rich sound. Instruments like the Khartal, Morchang and Bhapang, which are groove-based, work particularly well, complementing the deep bass from house beats," says Rahimtula. Electronic music wizard Simon Henner aka FRENCH 79, is playing in India for the first time. "I always adapt my live sets depending on the crowd and my feelings...but I will basically play the songs that are part of my Teenagers tour," says Henner. ■

–Neha Kirpal